

Assignment 2 – Stage 1

Requirement

Project overview (group 3-4 students)

Stage 1 (20 marks, due week 5):

The objective of stage 1 is to explore a data set and define a research question based on a research/business requirement. Activities include: (1) selecting a data set; (2) defining the problem and project requirements; (3) completing literature review and (4) exploring, summarising and preparing the data.

Report

The three-page report (not counting title page and references or appendix) should describe the problem, proposed approach and your data:

Section 1: Problem

- Describe the problem from a general perspective, highlighting the business/research need.
- List the research question(s) you will answer in stage 2 of the project.

Section 2: Literature review

- Describe 5-7 papers related to the problem listed in Section 1

Section 3: Approach

- Describe the approach you will take to solving the problem and any requirements. This is your plan for stage 2

Section 4: Data

- Describe the data from a general perspective e.g. source, size, fields of interest.
- How did you acquire the data?
- Describe any exploratory analysis you have done to refine your understanding of the data and research question. One or two supporting figures/tables would be great.
- Describe any data preparation e.g. transformation, sampling, cleaning.
- Which tools did you use to clean and explore the data set?

The report is worth 20% of the overall mark. It will be marked on data relevance, problem definition, data preparation, data summarisation and report completeness.

The report should use the high-level headings above (problem, approach, data). It should use line spacing of at least 1.15 and body font size of at least 10pt.

The goal is to convey the problem clearly and concisely.

Length:

stage 1: Report ~2000 words (excluding appendix, visualisations, and references)

Rubric

Assignment Stage 1 Rubric					
Criteria	Ratings				Pts
Literature Review	4 Pts Exceeds Expectations	2 Pts Meets Expectation	1 Pts Doesn't Meet Expectation	0 Pts No Literature Review	4 pts
Problem Definition	4 Pts problem and/or research questions are clear and concise	2 Pts problem and/or research questions are partially clear or too much detail	1 Pts problem and/or research questions not enough defined	0 Pts Problem not defined	4 pts
Problem Approach	2 Pts Problem approach is clearly described and appropriate	1 Pts Problem approach is partially clear or inappropriate	0.5 Pts Problem approach is unclear and/or inappropriate	0 Pts Approach not defined	2 pts
Data Set Relevancy	2 Pts data set is relevant and of appropriate complexity and size	1 Pts data set is chosen but not really relevant or very simple	0 Pts data set not chosen		2 pts
Data Summarisation	6 Pts descriptions summarises all and only relevant attributes clearly using text and figure(s). e.g. size, fields, completeness, distributions, correlations, etc. ; use of at least one figure	4 Pts the description summarises some or mostly relevant attribute	2 Pts the description is unclear or not relevant	0 Pts No Data Summarisation	6 pts
Report Structure and Style	2 Pts the report is clearly and concisely written, uses appropriate structure and figures, and is well formatted and within the given size limit	1 Pts report is within the given size limit and in general written well	0 Pts report is not well structured or formatted and way too short or too long		2 pts
Total points: 20					